

New Pool Owner Green Water Crisis — Action Checklist

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TEST AND BALANCE WATER CHEMISTRY

- ❑ **Test with Liquid Kit:** Use a Taylor K-2006 liquid test kit to get accurate readings of FC, CC, pH, TA, and CYA instead of relying on degraded test strips that give false readings at critical levels.
- ❑ **Balance Alkalinity First:** Add sodium bicarbonate to raise Total Alkalinity to 80-100 ppm before adjusting pH, because TA acts as a buffer that keeps pH stable and getting it wrong makes pH impossible to control.
- ❑ **Set pH to Target Range:** Adjust pH to 7.2-7.6 using muriatic acid to lower or soda ash to raise, making small adjustments and waiting 30 minutes before retesting each time.
- ❑ **Verify CYA Before Shocking:** Test your CYA level and drain 30-50% of the pool if it reads above 80 ppm, since high CYA locks out chlorine effectiveness and is likely why your pool turned green.

EXECUTE THE SLAM SHOCK PROCESS

- ❑ **Calculate Chlorine Dose:** Use the Taylor test kit SLAM chart to determine how much liquid chlorine to add based on your CYA level, targeting Free Chlorine levels of 16-24 ppm to kill algae effectively.
- ❑ **Add Liquid Chlorine:** Pour liquid chlorine (10-12% sodium hypochlorite) into the pool at the calculated shock dose to reach FC of 16-24 ppm, understanding that algae survives normal chlorine levels and requires this elevated dose to be killed.
- ❑ **Run Pump 24 Hours:** Keep your pool pump running continuously with the valve set to FILTER mode (not recirculate) during the entire SLAM process, because chlorine needs to move through the water and the filter must capture dead algae.
- ❑ **Brush Pool Surfaces Daily:** Use a stiff-bristle pool brush on walls, floors, steps, and corners once or twice daily during SLAM to break up algae biofilm that clings to surfaces and that vacuuming alone cannot remove.

CONFIRM RECOVERY AND MAINTAIN

- ☐ **Retest FC Daily:** Check your Free Chlorine level each morning and track the overnight loss, because FC holding steady overnight means the chlorine is no longer being consumed by contaminants and algae is dead.
 - ☐ **Confirm SLAM Completion:** The SLAM process is finished when FC loses less than 1 ppm overnight, CC is 0.5 ppm or below, and the water is clear enough to see the main drain fitting from the surface.
 - ☐ **Expect 3-7 Days for Recovery:** Plan for 3-7 days of SLAM treatment for moderate algae, with severe cases potentially taking up to 2 weeks, because the process requires patience and consistent chemical levels to fully clear the water.
 - ☐ **Store Chlorine Properly:** Keep liquid chlorine in a cool, dark place and use it within 1-2 months, because sunlight and heat degrade the active chlorine and reduce its effectiveness for future treatments.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.